

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Ella Gance

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS

Ella Gance

Collector, Style Patron & Society Fixture

Ella dresses as though the society pages arrive before the guests. Ella has excellent taste, excellent photographers, and excellent instincts about which artists will become impossible to buy next year.

- Collects work by **Vincent Van Faux** and **Elle Loominate**.
- Competes socially and at auction with **Elon Mosaic**.

ACTING TIPS

Charming, strategic, stylish, lightly competitive. Compliments can be sincere and still accomplish something.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Ella Gance. I collect beautiful things and attend beautiful evenings. I am prepared to be disappointed by neither.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

INTRODUCTIONS

Ella Gance

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant knew you quietly sold a work you had publicly promised to donate to another institution and planned to expose the contradiction.

Your other secret

You sold it to cover a failed business investment and hoped to replace it before anyone noticed.

Conversations to start

- Ask Vincent Van Faux what the museum expects a collector to donate.
- Compare gala expectations with Elon Mosaic. Keep your withdrawn donation private for now.

If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else. Your printed account may conceal another scandal, even if you are innocent. Stick to it during the hearings; save corrections for Coming Clean.

Memorize your animal and return the slip. When the host announces the selected animal, use IF MURDERER if it matches yours; otherwise use IF INNOCENT. Never read an IF heading aloud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

HUNT FOR CLUES

Ella Gance

The museum has misplaced its paperwork. Naturally.

Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the house. These three hints lead to three different hiding places. Leave the furniture and household objects where they are. Bring an envelope to the Evidence Table; read and share the discovery inside.

- 1** *The keyboard has a secret below middle C, but not among the keys.*
- 2** *Follow the streets of Barcelona with your eyes, then inspect what lies over them.*
- 3** *Find the household's frozen collection. One exhibit is made of paper.*

Already found? Read that discovery at the Evidence Table, then try another hint. Ask for help reaching a hiding place; nobody needs to climb. You may investigate together.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

ACT I: MOTIVE

Ella Gance

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant's financial plans threaten to take from you?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did Grant demand over a sale or purchase?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What unwelcome research did Grant want suppressed?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide, and why?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute demand put your work at risk?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What dispute made you want Grant's announcement stopped?

Any Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past decision was Grant threatening to expose?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant's decisions threaten your livelihood or work?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

ACT I: MOTIVE

Ella Gance

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

EVERYONE / READ ALOUD

Elegance requires discretion. Grant preferred a microphone. I sold a work I had publicly promised to donate to another institution. Grant knew and planned to expose the contradiction tonight. It was an ugly position, and he was preparing to turn my embarrassment into entertainment for the entire room.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

ACT II: OPPORTUNITY

Ella Gance

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

Where were you before the toast, and why?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What were you checking in the exhibition, and when?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What occupied you before Grant's private toast?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

Where did your work take you before the toast?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What were you examining before the unveiling, and when?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did you observe while the toast was prepared?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute work were you doing, and where?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

Where did you go before the toast, and why?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What drew you to the exhibition before the toast?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What were you arranging before Grant drank?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

ACT II: OPPORTUNITY

Ella Gance

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

When the brass clock said 6:44, I admired the glaze from inside the display alcove. I was on the gallery balcony by the time of the toast. I needed a little distance from Grant, and not solely to appreciate the composition.

IF MURDERER

My last inspection was inside the Star Bowl alcove, about 6:43 by the service-desk clock. I went there to admire the blue glaze beside the cabinet's polished brass corner posts. I wanted to know whether the object or the lighting deserved the applause. I tried to recover my purchase papers at the salon doorway.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

ACT III: METHOD

Ella Gance

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did you handle or conceal during setup?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What materials or records passed through your hands?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did you borrow, conceal or change tonight?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

What did you alter that could look suspicious?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What did you discover or conceal in your work?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

Which objects or records need your explanation?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What changed during setup, and what did you do?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What might someone misinterpret about your preparations?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What part of your past or preparation needs explaining?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What passed through your hands that matters tonight?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

ACT III: METHOD

Ella Gance

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

EVERYONE / READ ALOUD

I sold a work I had promised to donate, after a business investment failed. I hoped to replace it before anyone noticed. Grant noticed. I have cultivated the impression that everything in my life is beautifully arranged. This was not. I was preparing to own the embarrassment rather than let him stage it for me.

Evidence Table / discovery index

- | | |
|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| 1. Gift agreement | 9. Education reallocation |
| 2. Shipping manifest / 1988 | 10. Donor Salon camera |
| 3. A warning left behind | 11. Donation entry / 1989 |
| 4. GRANT'S NIGHT OF GLORY | 12. Closing reveal / concept |
| 5. Treatment finding | 13. Display proposal / superseded |
| 6. Donor agreement / margin copy | 14. Clock inspection slip |
| 7. Auction result | 15. Cancelled programme cue |
| 8. Vincent Van Faux | 16. Grant Larceny's toast |



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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ACCUSATIONS

Ella Gance

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Fold this loose page writing inward and give only the ballot to the host. Keep your packet for Coming Clean. Votes lock when all ballots are collected.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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COMING CLEAN

Ella Gance

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. If none confesses, the host calls the selected animal to stand. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I sold a work I had promised to donate. My account of the evening was true. The brass gallery clock was ten minutes fast: the time I quoted from it belongs ten minutes earlier, before the alcove closed. My concealed business explains the suspicion around me. I did not poison Grant, and I will answer for my own secret without accepting his murder.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

Elegance requires discretion. Grant preferred a microphone. I sold a work I had publicly promised to donate to another institution. Grant knew and planned to expose the contradiction tonight. It was an ugly position, and he was preparing to turn my embarrassment into entertainment for the entire room. I stole the toxin and wiped it inside Grant's empty coupe with museum linen before the cordial was poured. I invented a late alcove visit from the old programme and enclosed-cabinet drawing. I had missed both the early closure and the open-cradle installation. Others lied about their times to hide scandals; my claimed work never happened at all. I was at Grant's glass instead. I acted alone. I poisoned Grant Larceny.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.